

VARSHA SATHYANARAYANAN

Category Manager

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CONTACT

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EDUCATION

Humber College, Longo School of Business

Graduate Certificate in Fashion Management

Toronto, Canada | Sept 2023, Aug 2024

National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT)

Bachelor of Design, Fashion Design

Chennai, India | July 2016, July 2020

SKILLS

Core CompetenciesAssortment Planning · Fashion Buying · PO/PI Coordination · Vendor Management · Inventory · Forecasting · TNA Calendar Tracking · Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) · Order TrackingToolsAdvanced MS Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Dashboards) · MS Word · Google Sheets · Canva · Meta Ads · SAP (PO/Inventory Tracking - Basic)Functional StrengthsCross-Functional Collaboration · Trend Analysis · Sales Performance Reporting · Catalog & Content · E-commerce Marketing · Vendor Negotiation

PROFILE

Data-driven merchandiser with relevant experience in buying, category management, and P&L ownership across omnichannel retail. Proven track record of scaling categories from near zero to 25+ subcategories, improving margins from 22% to 35%, and driving sell-through through assortment optimization and vendor negotiation. Skilled in OTB planning, advanced Excel, and cross-functional collaboration to deliver profitable growth in fast-paced value retail environments.

EXPERIENCE

Category Manager - Fashion

SuperK, Bangalore, India

Nov 2024 - Present

- Built the fashion category from near zero across online channels and a tech-enabled retail network of 3+ coco stores, launching assortments across apparel, footwear, and accessories while driving vendor expansion, category P&L management, and data-led merchandising decisions.
- Built fashion category from 5 to 25+ subcategories across menswear, womenswear, kidswear, footwear, and accessories by onboarding 12+ regional vendors, identifying assortment gaps, and benchmarking against value retailers like DMart and Vishal Mega Mart.
 - Drove ₹3.5 lakh in category revenue within two months by analyzing weekly sales, pricing benchmarks, and customer demand signals to optimize sell-through.
 - Improved product margins from 22% to 35% through vendor negotiation on pricing, MOQs, and sourcing terms while maintaining competitive retail pricing.
 - Partnered with marketing to launch fashion-led campaigns during New Year, Pongal, and Republic Day, increasing category visibility by ~22% and driving ~15% uplift in campaign period sales.
 - Reduced stock-outs by ~20% across priority products by collaborating with operations and supply chain to improve stock availability and coordinate warehouse invoicing and inventory flow.
 - Tracked sell-through, AOV, and margin performance using Excel and Metabase dashboards; identified underperforming SKUs and implemented assortment rationalization that improved category gross margin by ~6%.

Founder

The Style Gram, Remote - Chennai, India

Nov 2024 - Jun 2025

- Built and operated a lean fashion reselling brand focused on affordable women's western-wear, managing end-to-end sourcing, merchandising, content creation, and customer engagement across Instagram and Swiggy Minis.
- Generated ₹50,000 in revenue during the launch phase with an average order value of ₹600, fulfilling 80+ customer orders across Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities with zero product returns.
 - Sourced and merchandised 60+ SKUs across tops, skirts, and dresses through direct supplier negotiations, maintaining 45% gross margins and reducing sourcing turnaround time by 25%.
 - Evaluated and engaged 5 supplier partners before finalizing a primary vendor to optimize pricing, quality consistency, and procurement turnaround time.
 - Executed pricing, merchandising, and inventory tracking through Excel-based systems, ensuring 100% order fulfillment and streamlined stock management.
 - Managed 60+ SKUs on Swiggy Minis and built a custom Excel-based WIP tracker to manage catalog listings, order tracking, and inventory visibility, reducing catalog errors by 90% and improving stock flow for fast-selling styles.
 - Produced 25+ branded content assets and launched 3+ Instagram ad campaigns, improving click-through rates by 22% through A/B testing and targeted messaging.

Assistant Fashion Manager

Go Colors (Go Fashion India Ltd.), Chennai, India

Sept 2020 - June 2023

- Supported buying and merchandising for women's and girls' bottom-wear categories including leggings, track pants, formal pants, ethnic bottoms, and shorts, with responsibility for vendor coordination, product lifecycle execution, and data-led assortment decisions.
- Managed PO/PI coordination and vendor communication across 20+ suppliers and 10+ factories across India and Asia, ensuring 95% on-time delivery for seasonal production orders.
 - Improved category sell-through by 15% by analyzing weekly sales performance for 200+ SKUs and recommending replenishment and assortment adjustments.
 - Drove a 10% lift in customer purchase rate across key bottom-wear categories by aligning assortment planning with trend insights and performance data.
 - Launched 3+ new sub-categories including kids-wear, leading a 2-member team to introduce new styles and revamp existing collections, boosting category sales by 15% in the first quarter.
 - Negotiated supplier pricing and MOQs during fabric sourcing and production planning, maintaining product quality while ensuring competitive margins.
 - Led sampling, fit approvals, and production coordination for 30+ styles per season, reducing post-launch return rates to under 10% while gaining exposure to PLM-driven product development workflows.
 - Built WIP trackers to monitor production timelines and collaborated with logistics, VM, and marketing teams to ensure timely product launches.